



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Rosary Academy
School Website: <https://hraak.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Rosary Academy (Anchorage, AK; ZIP 99503) presents a cohesive classical-Catholic program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education. Public materials from the school emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books and Western canonical works, and pedagogical practices such as seminars, oral recitation, and a thesis-based senior project. The school situates education within a Catholic theological framework, incorporating Mass, the Rosary, and liturgical practices as central to daily life. Family partnership and parental formation are foregrounded, with explicit statements about assisting parents as primary educators. Across six categories, Holy Rosary Academy demonstrates a predominantly CLASSICAL orientation, with robust evidence of religious-metaphysical foundations, formation-focused aims, liberal-arts curriculum, Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy, a living-faculty model, and active parent/community partnership. No substantive signals in public materials indicate a drift toward non-classical orientations.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly prioritized via Catholic liturgy, theology, and the integration of faith with reason (Mass, Rosary, theology, Saint Augustine/Aquinas references). This category is CLASSICAL. - The school's stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and truth—a core hallmark of classical education. This category is CLASSICAL. - Curriculum is built around the Trivium, Great Books, Western civilization, Latin, and seminar-style study, with history treated as part of Western civilization rather than as "social studies." This category is CLASSICAL. - Pedagogy blends contemplative/restful elements (Schol  ), memorization/recitation, and upper-school rhetoric/seminars, with explicit mention of seminars and the thesis in the rhetoric stage. This category is CLASSICAL. - The faculty is presented as well-qualified and formation-oriented, with named staff and a Dean of Formation, illustrating the living-curriculum model. This category is CLASSICAL. - Parental involvement and community engagement are foregrounded (plan visits, parental formation, partnership with families). This category is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school identifies itself as a "PreK-12 classical school in the Roman Catholic Tradition" and emphasizes forming students in faith, reason, and virtue. This Catholic framing is explicit in mission statements and page copy. - Public materials stress liturgical life and Catholic practice (Mass, Rosary, Stations of the Cross) as daily life components. - References to theology and integration of faith with reason appear, including quotes about faith and reason as "two wings" on which the human spirit rises to truth. - Great ideas are framed within a Catholic intellectual tradition (Homer through Augustine and Aquinas are discussed in seminars).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (from the Six Elements lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Mass; worship; sacred; holy; reverence; wonder. - Negative keywords present: relativism is explicitly contrasted in some materials ("In a world swayed by relativism..."). No explicit secular-humanist or value-neutral signals appear as main framing in the public content. - Frequency

note: Multiple explicit mentions of Mass, Rosary, theology, liturgical life, and Catholic tradition appear across materials, with fewer explicit relativist signals.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendental truths (truth, beauty, goodness) within a liturgical Catholic framework and treats theology as central to education. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations and offsets any relativism signals. Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Citations: Catholic/tradition framing and liturgical life references appear in mission and program pages (e.g., “PreK-12 classical school in the Roman Catholic Tradition,” Mass/Rosary) , , .

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials declare formation as the aim: forming students in faith, reason, and virtue; human excellence and wisdom are named as goals beyond mere information. - Language emphasizes cultivation of wisdom and virtue, and pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, not merely informational outcomes. - Emphasis on liberal education, great conversation, and the formation of character is evident in program descriptions and Great-Book oriented claims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal education, great conversation, holistic education, formation of affections, moral imagination. - Negative keywords present: minimal; the public materials do not foreground “career readiness” or job-work terms as primary aims. - Frequency note: Strong presence of formation-language and classical-education aims; limited negative signals.

Why this rating - The materials consistently describe education as formation and cultivation of virtue and wisdom, aligned with classical aims rather than workforce-centric outcomes. CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission/Philosophy statements and “Pursuit of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” language (turn0file4, turn0file9) and references to great-conversation and liberal education (turn0file3) , , .

Element 3: School Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The Trivium is named as the core of study: grammar, logic, rhetoric, with memory, reasoning, and communication emphasized. - Great Books and Western civilization are foregrounded (Homer, Plato, Augustine, Dante, Dostoevsky, Beowulf, The Odyssey, Canterbury Tales, etc.). - Latin and classical languages are part of the program (Rhetoric Stage mentions Latin; high school content includes advanced study). - History is placed within the Western civilization/cultural heritage frame rather than as “social studies.” The materials emphasize a Western-civilization curriculum and primary sources.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Western civilization; Latin; history (as narrative/chronology); primary sources; sacred/Christian tradition (in a historical sense). - Negative keywords present: “social studies” framing is not used; no dominant presence of project-based or STEM-first language in the curricular description; some modernity-leaning terms are not foregrounded. - Frequency note: Strong presence of classical curriculum keywords; limited/no explicit negative signals in the public-facing curriculum text.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly anchored in classical-education terms (Trivium, Great Books, Western Civilization, Latin). This meets the core Curriculum signals for CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium and Great Books references (turn0file0; turn0file3; turn0file7; turn0file14) , , , .

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) is described as part of the pedagogy, with focus on contemplative learning and memory work. - Lower-school practices include singing, chanting, and memory-based activities (recitation and chant) to deepen memory and delight. - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes

Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetorical training; students engage in debates, discussions, and exposition. - The rhetoric stage culminates in student theses and spoken/declamatory expression, aligning with classical rhetoric training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé, contemplative learning, restfulness, memorization/recitation, chanting, Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetorical training, debates, thesis, proclamation. - Negative keywords present: The public materials do not emphasize experiential-only or purely project-based pedagogy as the sole approach; those approaches are not foregrounded in opposition here. - Frequency note: The Pedagogy section shows a balanced integration of both contemplative (lower-intensity) and dialectical/rhetorical methods.

Why this rating - The evidence demonstrates a deliberate incorporation of both contemplative/restful methods and high-level dialectic/rhetoric activities, which is characteristic of CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Citations: Pedagogical methods and high-school seminars (turn0file18; turn0file7) , .

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school notes “well-qualified and faith-filled faculty and staff” as a core condition for student formation. - Public materials name specific faculty roles and individuals (e.g., Upper School Faculty; Dean of Formation; Dean of Student Life), illustrating a living, organized faculty structure. , - The faculty is positioned as part of the living curriculum and the school’s mission to form virtuous scholars, not merely as service providers.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, faculty as mentors, portrait of teacher, collegiality, mastery, formation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public content; no signals of a “teacher-as-facilitator only” detracting from classical aims. - Frequency note: Multiple references to faculty quality, roles, and formation emphasis.

Why this rating - The public materials align with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty as exemplars, mentors, and the core of the school’s mission, with named roles and a formation-focused framing.

Citations: General faculty quality (turn0file0), specific faculty pages (turn0file15) , .

Element 6: Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school presents itself as forming students with parents as primary educators; mission text explicitly states assisting parents in faith, reason, and virtue. - There are explicit calls to plan visits and tours, indicating openness to parental engagement and transparency. - The public materials describe partnerships with families and community events, and offer opportunities for parent involvement in learning communities (e.g., book groups, gatherings) per the classical-model expectations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental formation; home-school collaboration; open-campus; family involvement; parent formation. - Negative keywords present: none in the public-facing materials; no signals of parent as mere customers or minimal involvement. - Frequency note: Strong presence of parental partnership language and community engagement signals.

Why this rating - The school clearly embraces a parental-partnership model and ongoing parental formation, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations: Mission statements and parent-focused language (turn0file4), visit-planning language (turn0file14) , .

Aggregate Rating

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL

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- Element 5: CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Not applicable since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category currently signals a move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL based on the public materials reviewed. No needle-moving changes are required to achieve a fully CLASSICAL standing.

Abstract (summary)

Holy Rosary Academy, Anchorage AK 99503, presents a coherent, publicly stated classical-Catholic education. The six-category analysis shows CLASSICAL alignment across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Catholic liturgy and theology), School Purpose and Goal (formation-focused aims), Curriculum (Trivium grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; Western civilization; Latin), Pedagogy (Scholé/restful learning; memorization and recitation; Socratic seminars and rhetoric), Faculty (living-curriculum with named roles and formation emphasis), and Parents & Community (parent partnerships and accessible campus visits). The school's public materials consistently reflect the transcendental aims of classical education (truth, goodness, beauty) harmonized with a Catholic worldview, and they present a robust model of faculty and parent involvement consistent with classical ideals. This positions Holy Rosary Academy as CLASSICAL in the spectrum of classical education.

Citations and sources used (example): - Mission, Catholic identity, and Trivium emphasis: Holy Rosary Academy materials (turn0file0, turn0file4) , . - Great Books and seminars; Western civilization; philosophical/literary canon references: Seminar content and Great Books references (turn0file3, turn0file7) , . - Liturgy and Catholic formation (Mass, Rosary, Stations of the Cross): (turn0file0, turn0file3) , . - Faculty roles and examples: (turn0file11, turn0file15) , . - Parental partnership and visits: (turn0file4, turn0file14) , . - Classical keyword framework (positive/negative indicators): Six Elements lexicon and doc excerpts (turn0file9, turn0file10, turn0file16, turn0file18) , , , .

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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